

I want to participate in the Japan Exchange Teaching (JET) program as an Assistant Language Teacher (ALT) because it is the fusion of my desire to experience Japan and my passion to promote internationalization through education and learning. Japan has captured my imagination from a very young age. While growing up in a household where history and world affairs were the topics of daily discussions, Japan was portrayed to me as a land of contrasts and a nation of hardworking and kind people. In the aftermath of the Fukushima disaster, the resilience and determination of the Japanese nation reinforced my image of Japan, and inspired me to experience the aspects of Japanese culture. JET program will enable me to experience the Japanese society through one of the best ways of acculturation, that is basic education system, and allow me to participate in it as an English teacher.

I am enthusiastic about mentoring, and transferring my knowledge in the best possible way. I have put my passion for teaching into practice through tutoring math and physics to my peers, leading the English conversation circles offered by the University of Michigan to international students, and now by teaching English to beginners and intermediate English-learners in a community learning program. Furthermore, I participated in study abroad programs in China and Korea in 2012 and 2013, respectively. I took courses in these respective countries' language and culture during each trip. As a multilingual, I can connect with students at a personal level due to my own language learning experiences. My multicultural background also enables me to understand the expectations and challenges of language learners and the role of cultural perspectives in teaching a language. I am planning to use these skills and knowledge as an instrument of internationalization by ensuring that my students will learn English through American cultural outlook.

¶As an ALT, I will use my academic and professional learning experiences to optimize my

methods of instruction. I took multiple engineering courses in college before changing my major to Political Science. My academic pathway through Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math (STEM) and Social Sciences has equipped me with important teaching tools like critical thinking, intuition, and logical reasoning. Additionally, I am taking an introductory linguistics course in order to have a better understanding of language transfer mechanisms. I also understand how challenging life can be outside of the classroom for my students. I myself struggled to maintain a steady grade point average during my undergraduate education as I was employed full time. However, that struggle has taught me valuable lessons about myself and prepared me for greater challenges in life. I worked for major insurance companies, including Allstate and Nationwide, for seven years. I started as a receptionist and worked my way up to the position of Associate Agent. My work focused on customer service and public relations for a multilingual and multi-ethnic client base. I learned effective communication, creative thinking, teamwork, leadership and goal orientation in a variety of situations. My goal is to apply the same professional standards as a JET employee, by providing a creative and fun based learning experience for the students through mutual understanding and teamwork.

¶My acceptance in the JET program will advance my personal and professional development. JET program will further broaden my international experience and the understanding of global community. My purpose is to provide mutually beneficial learning experience while representing the United States in Japan as an assimilated global citizen. In the future, I plan to extend my JET experience by working with UNESCO and other international educational organizations as an educationalist. Above all, as an American teaching English in Japan, I will be contributing my personal initiative, skills, and knowledge to an effort greater than myself and with constructive global impact.